



SQL ENGINEERING HANDBOOK

Practice Datasets

Public repositories for hands-on query practice

Datasets

Part of the [Resources Library](#) — [SQL Engineering Handbook](#)

For practice beyond this repo's own [datasets/](#) folder (employee_management, ecommerce, sales, finance, healthcare, nagpurlens). Once the Handbook's own schema feels comfortable, importing one of these into a local database is the natural next step — real data is messier than curated exercise data on purpose.

Dataset Source	What It Is	Best For	Free / Paid
Kaggle Datasets	The largest general-purpose public dataset hub, spanning every domain	Broad selection with community notebooks showing how others approached the same data	Free
data.gov	The U.S. government's open data portal	Large, realistic government/civic datasets — good for practicing messy real-world joins	Free
UCI Machine Learning Repository	Long-standing academic dataset repository, originally built for ML research	Clean, well-documented classic datasets with clear schemas	Free
NYC Open Data	New York City's open government data portal	City-scale operational data (transit, permits, 311 calls) — excellent for GROUP BY and date-function practice	Free
data.gov.in	India's open government data portal	Practicing SQL against Indian civic/government datasets, directly relevant if projects like nagpurlens are on your mind	Free

[!TIP] Pick a dataset with at least three related tables before importing it — single flat CSVs don't exercise joins, which is most of what real SQL work actually is.

Next: [playgrounds.md](#). Back to [Resources Library](#).